

YACHT NEWS TURKIYE

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TURKIYE YACHT BUILDING 2025

Mapping Turkiye's Production Culture
Special Feature
by Aslı Sağbilge

A NEW GIANT TAKES SHAPE IN TURKIYE

*AKYACHT's 120m+ Project
NB012 Begins*

TURKIYE'S NEW YACHTING

DESTINATION
Gazipaşa Gold Marina

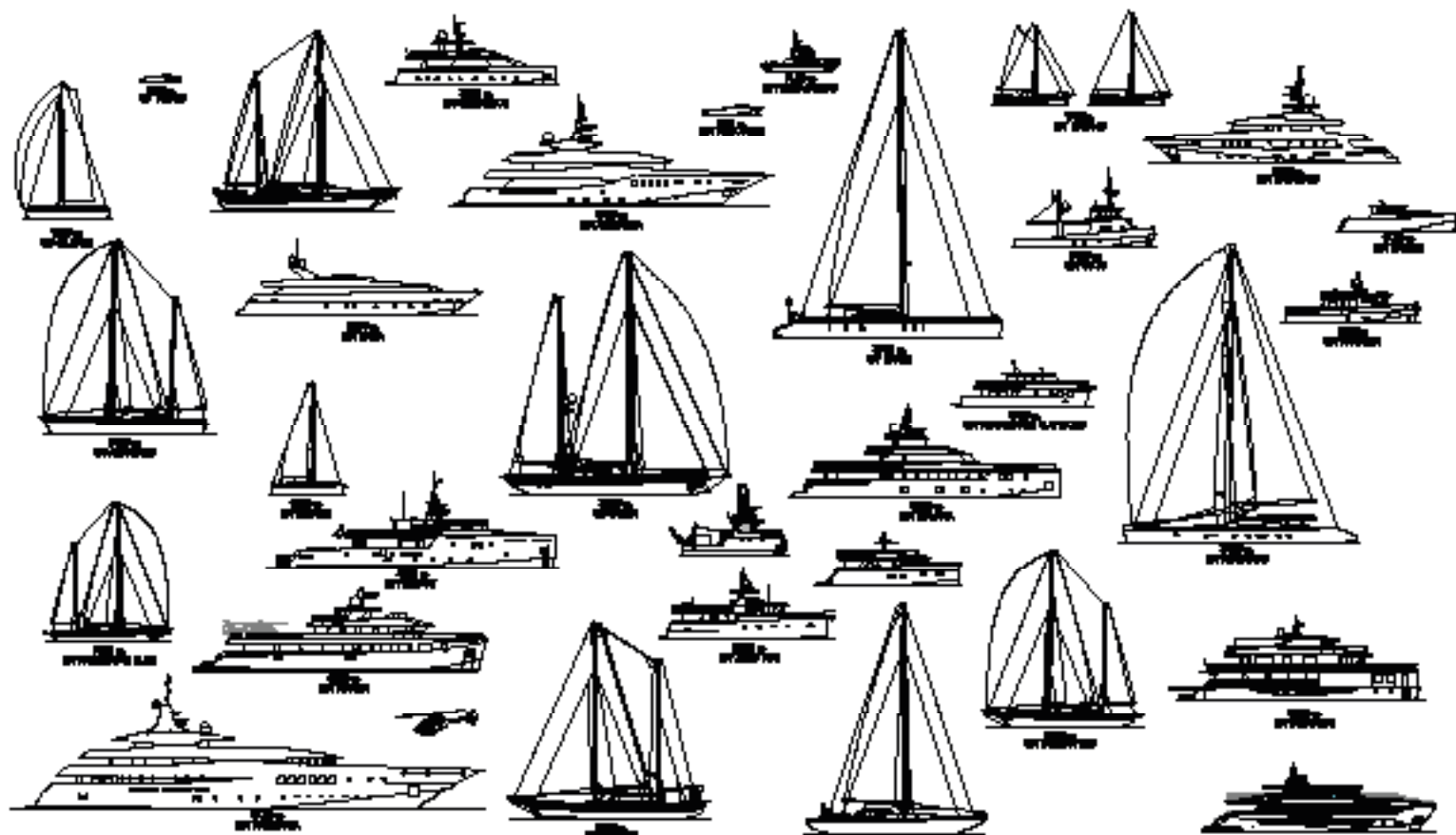


Special edition

M/Y *Amanda*

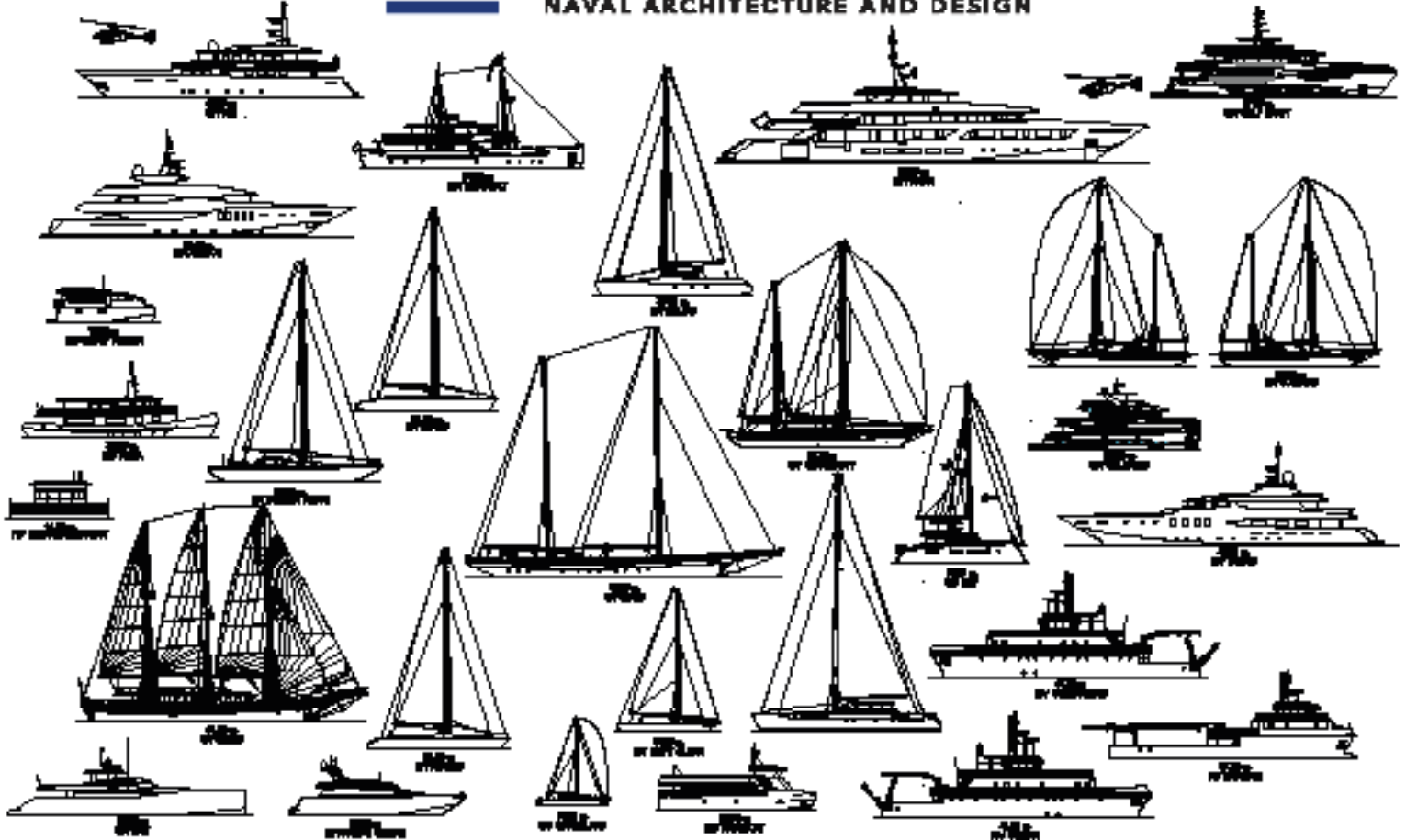
Nebula's Flagship with **EO** signature

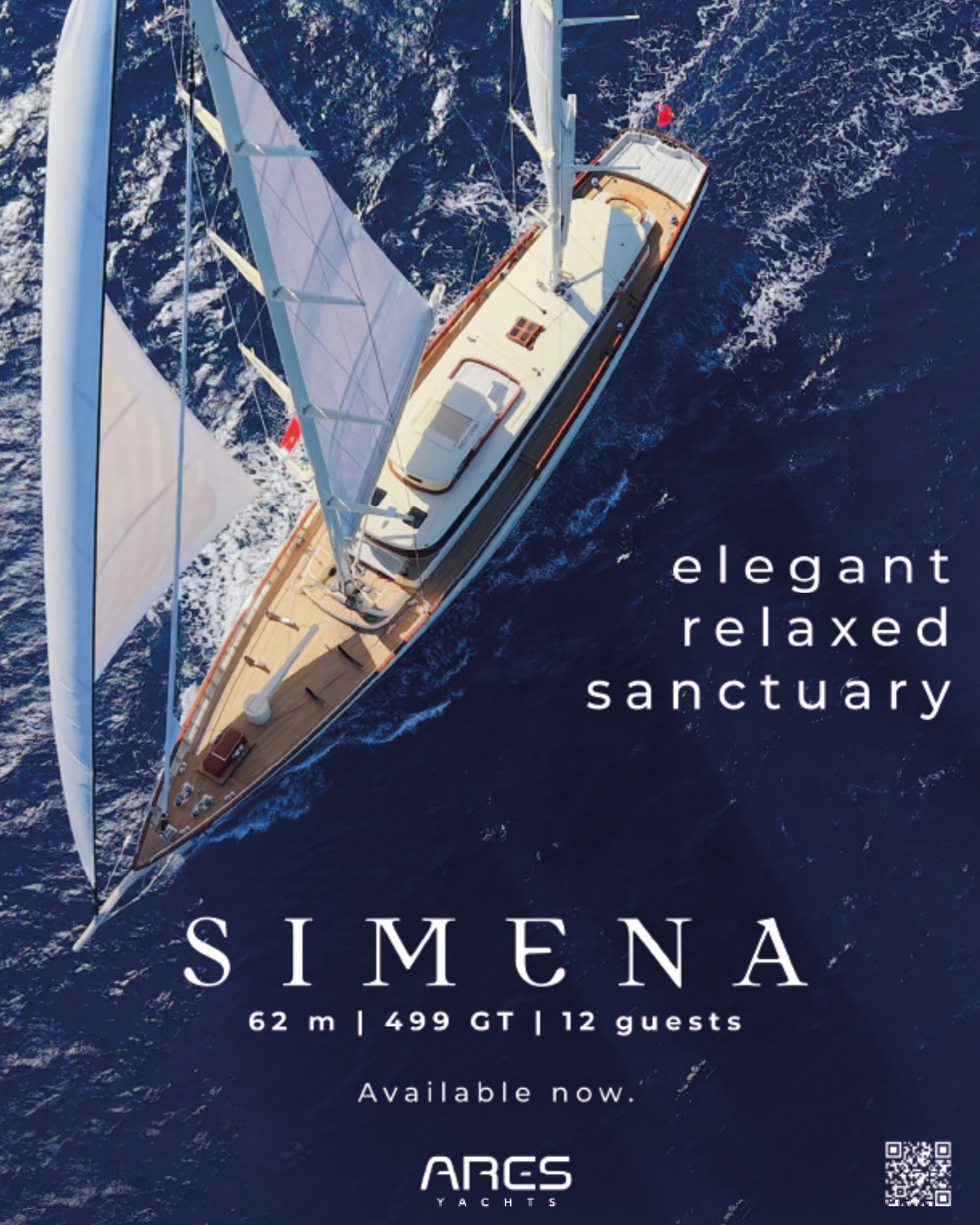
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SOYASLAN

NAVAL ARCHITECTURE AND DESIGN



An aerial photograph of a large sailboat, the SIMENA, sailing on a deep blue ocean. The boat is white with a wooden deck and large white sails. It is moving from the top left towards the bottom right, leaving a white wake. The text "elegant relaxed sanctuary" is overlaid on the right side of the image.

elegant
relaxed
sanctuary

SIMENA

62 m | 499 GT | 12 guests

Available now.

ARES
YACHTS



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YACHT NEWS

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Meral ER
Editor in Chief

Some issues carry a meaning that extends beyond the period in which they are published. Yat Haber Türkiye Issue 57, released as the January–February 2026 edition, stands precisely at this point. Prepared as a Boot Düsseldorf special issue, it records the sectoral memory of the past year while offering a strong framework for the trends shaping the new period.

Throughout 2025, Yat Haber Türkiye pursued an editorial approach rooted in on-site presence, actively participating in international yacht and maritime fairs. We observed globally emerging trends firsthand, from production and technology to design and infrastructure, through a broad and comprehensive perspective. As we enter 2026, our editorial stance is clear: to build a narrative that is more visible, more in-depth, and more international at every point of contact.

At the core of this issue is the special feature titled **“A Sectoral Reading of Turkish Yacht Building in 2025.”** Prepared with the aim of presenting an up-to-date and reliable snapshot of the Turkish yacht-building industry, this study brings together yachts built and currently under construction in Turkish shipyards during 2025, based on shipyard-verified data. By making scale, capacity, and production trends visible, this comprehensive work should be regarded as a reference archive—one that goes beyond individual projects to enable a broader reading of the sector’s current position and future potential.

Our cover story, Amanda by Nebula Yacht, anchors the Craftsmanship & Innovation section, where we explore the concepts of mastery and innovation through the lenses of design and production. For Nebula Yacht, Amanda represents more than a single project—it embodies a stance. This 57-meter motor yacht reflects a production culture rooted in Antalya that has found a clear and confident language on the global superyacht stage. As much as it defines the brand’s present, it also makes its ambitions for the future visible. Amanda emerges as the natural result of a process in which design, engineering, and craftsmanship progress along the same line, shaping a distinct identity.

The Bulletin section supports the editorial framework of this issue with up-to-date developments and content reflecting the dynamic structure of the industry. Data shared by the Ship, Yacht and Services Exporters’ Association reveal that the Turkish ship and yacht sector closed 2025 with a strong export performance, record figures, and high value-added production. Coming after a period of intensified global competition, these results clearly demonstrate the sector’s structural maturity and sustainable growth capacity.

On the infrastructure side, Gold Marina, which began operations in Gazipaşa as Türkiye’s 65th marina, stands out as a noteworthy development for the Eastern Mediterranean route. With a capacity of 208 berths, this new investment represents not only a marina project but also a strategic expansion of the region’s yacht tourism vision.

On the production front, the ambition of Turkish shipyards positioned in the global league with projects exceeding 100 meters finds strong reflection in this issue. The steel-cutting ceremony held by AKYACHT for its NB012 project marks the beginning of a significant phase, transitioning from design and engineering to production.

In the Exhibition section, we share on-site insights from METSTRIDE 2025, highlighting Turkish companies’ advanced engineering solutions, sustainability-focused products, and their engagement with international visitors. Meanwhile, D-Marin’s achievement of seven awards across four marinas at the Abu Dhabi Maritime Awards stands out as a strong example of how regional benchmarks in marina management are being defined.

The Voices of Industry pages bring together strong perspectives from different layers of the sector through exclusive interviews, ranging from ARES Yachts to Tortur Denizcilik and SAKEN, spanning diverse disciplines.

The Yacht Club section, with its vibrant and curated content, completes the rhythm of this issue on a more relaxed note.

Beyond marking the close of a year, this issue serves as a threshold—refreshing sectoral memory and offering a clearer view forward as we step into 2026.

Enjoy the read.

With kind regards,

AMANDA

Where Craftsmanship
Becomes Identity



For Nebula Yacht, Amanda represents more than a project—it embodies a clear stance. This 57-meter motor yacht translates Antalya's production culture into a language that is effortlessly legible on the global superyacht stage, defining not only the brand's present but also making its ambitions for the future visible. Amanda emerges as the natural outcome of a process in which design, engineering, and craftsmanship advance along the same line, collectively building a distinct identity.

Nebula Yacht's approach in recent years has evolved around a vision that brings together scale, impact, and technical depth within a single framework. Carefully considered proportions, balanced volumes, and a long-term perspective on use form the core pillars of this vision. Amanda is its clearest expression. The production process that began in Antalya demonstrates with confidence that local expertise can speak powerfully on the global superyacht stage.



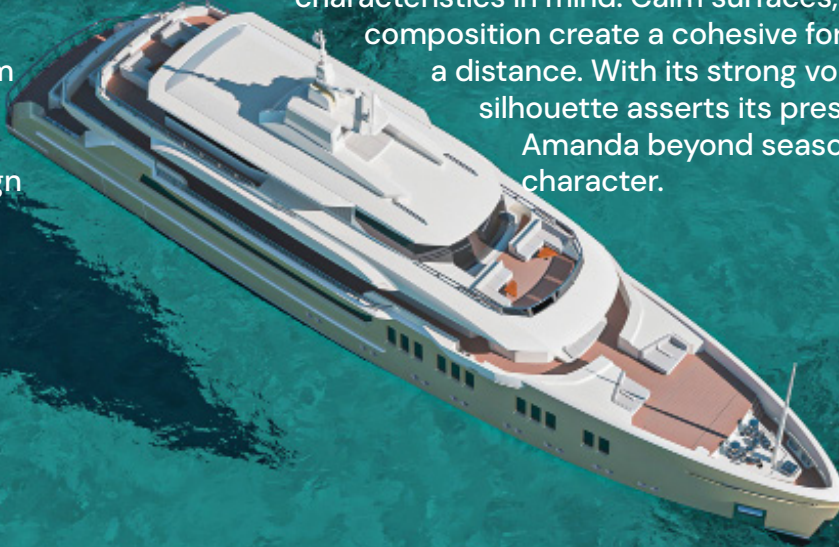
Exterior Design

Espen Øino International–Timeless Proportions

Amanda's silhouette carries the signature approach of Espen Øino International. For the Monaco-based studio, aesthetics are never pursued independently of engineering; proportion, function, and performance are conceived together. This philosophy is clearly evident in Amanda.

The hull and superstructure proportions have been optimized with stability, volume efficiency, and seakeeping and an overall recognizable from stance, the elevating long lasting design

characteristics in mind. Calm surfaces, controlled lines, composition create a cohesive form that is instantly a distance. With its strong volumes and confident silhouette asserts its presence at first glance, Amanda beyond seasonal trends into a character.





Interior Design

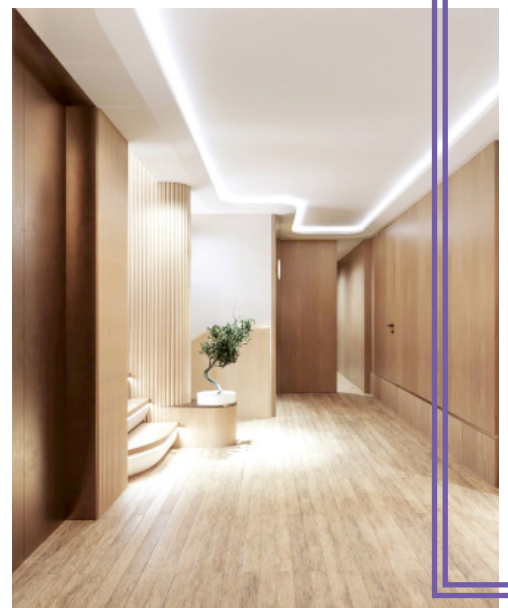
Matteo Gennari

A Balanced and Refined Living Concept

Inside, Amanda is shaped by Matteo Gennari's measured and architectural approach. The interiors are conceived as a holistic living environment that brings together volume, comfort, and visual impact.



The layout is structured around a strong sense of flow, accommodating both private use and charter operations with equal ease. A seamless relationship between interior and exterior living spaces is a central objective, with circulation efficiency and spatial continuity prioritized throughout. Material selections, surface detailing, and volumetric transitions are guided by criteria of long-term use, ease of maintenance, and manufacturability. The resulting atmosphere defines a refined superyacht interior designed to retain its value over time.



Craftsmanship

A Production Discipline Built in Antalya

Amanda clearly reflects Nebula Yacht's shipyard culture in Antalya. The production process moves away from serial reflexes, advancing instead through a project-based discipline. From hull construction and system integration to interior applications and detailed solutions, a consistent perception of quality is evident at every stage.

This approach goes beyond merely executing designers' lines, transforming the project into a cohesive production work. Amanda is the product of an understanding in which craftsmanship is not a showcase element, but the value itself.



Innovation

Power, Comfort, and Environmental Balance

Amanda occupies a distinctive position as the largest motor yacht built in Türkiye to feature a diesel-electric propulsion system. This technical choice clearly defines the project's innovation strategy.

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The diesel-electric propulsion system delivers operational efficiency, low vibration levels, and enhanced acoustic comfort, while also providing an infrastructure that reduces environmental impact. Long-range capability, system integration, and advanced energy management form the technical backbone of the project.

Technology is configured to operate in harmony with design and living spaces, positioning Amanda as a platform that not only meets today's superyacht expectations but is also prepared for future regulations and evolving usage scenarios.



Local Strength, Global Identity

With contributions from global references such as Espen Øino International and Matteo Gennari combined with Nebula Yacht's local production expertise, Amanda acquires an identity that is confidently positioned on the international stage. Design, engineering, and craftsmanship progress around a shared vision, without overshadowing one another.

For Nebula Yacht, Amanda represents both a milestone and a signature. Rising from Antalya, this project stands as a strong and enduring reference point for the brand's future in the world of superyachts.

Technical Specification

Length Overall (LOA)	57.62 m
Beam	11.50 m
Gross Tonnage	1,250 GT
Hull / Superstructure	Steel / Aluminium
Propulsion	Diesel-Electric
Max Speed	16.5 knots

Cruising Speed	10 knots
Range	5,000 nm @ 10 knots
Guests / Crew	14 / 12
Exterior Design	Espen Øino International
Interior Design	Matteo Gennari
Shipyard	Nebula Yacht





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CABANA

Mengi Yay Unveils First Interior Images of Its Landmark Project Cabana



Mengi Yay has released the first interior visuals of NB 111 – CABANA, a project developed with the shipyard's new-generation design philosophy. Cabana, measuring 34.48 meters in length with an 8.25-meter beam, features a steel hull and aluminum superstructure, positioning it as a new member of the modern explorer yacht class. With a gross tonnage of approximately 330 GT, the yacht is designed for long-range cruising and is powered by twin Volvo Penta D16 MH engines.





The main saloon stands out with an open and fluid layout that makes full use of the yacht's beam. Large side windows draw natural light throughout the day while offering uninterrupted views even from a seated position. Light-toned wood surfaces and vertical panels add both warmth and balanced acoustic performance to the space.



Cabana's modular seating arrangement allows the saloon to adapt to various usage scenarios, while marine-grade modern lounge chairs bring both elegance and comfort. Ceiling-integrated LED strips and complementary spot lighting create a soft, inviting atmosphere suitable for any time of day.

The upper-deck lounge, highlighted in the first visuals, showcases one of Cabana's strongest social zones. Expansive windows and sliding glass doors minimize the sense of enclosure, while low-profile modular seating creates a layout ideal for extended gatherings.

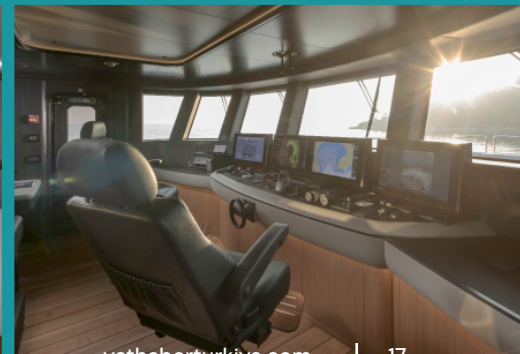
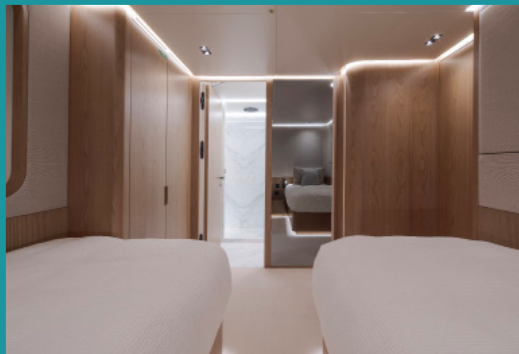


Angled window frames enhance panoramic views, and design details such as textured flooring and an integrated minibar elevate comfort during long passages.

Another standout area in the released images is the owner's suite. A calm, refined atmosphere is created through natural tones, with large window openings allowing daylight to spread evenly across the space.

Finely crafted wood panels, soft textures and smart storage solutions transform the suite into a serene, thoughtfully composed private retreat.

The newly released interior images strongly reflect Cabana's modern design language, offering a first glimpse into the yacht's sophisticated and contemporary character.



ENGINEERING

THAT BEGINS IN THE DETAILS



SEA DESIGN

In maritime engineering, the real difference often emerges at decision points that are not immediately visible. Stability calculations, structural strength analyses, and hull form optimizations—these technical details define a yacht's performance and guide its long-term safety and sustainability.

Founded in 2022, SEA Design operates within this engineering framework. Backed by more than 20 years of industry experience, the team—led by Selçuk Adaoğlu, Alper Laçın, and Ertan Özgür Alkanoğlu—approaches every project as a distinct engineering challenge, going beyond established standards to develop tailored technical solutions.

Technical Decisions That Define Character in New Builds

In new-build projects, performance is shaped not only by engine power, but by hull form, weight distribution, and structural integrity. In SEA Design's projects, 3D modeling, hull and weight optimization, and shipyard production support are evaluated within a unified engineering framework from the very beginning of the process.

Compliance with international classification society rules is regarded not as a formality, but as an integral part of the design itself. This approach ensures that projects advance in line with global standards.

Structural Reconfiguration in Conversion Projects

Refit and modernization works on existing yachts often require engineering solutions as complex as those of new builds. Lengthening and beam expansion, capacity upgrades, and structural modifications redefine a yacht's balance entirely.

SEA Design's work in this field is shaped by performance-driven technical decisions, developed within the framework of operational requirements.

Engineering Throughout the Lifecycle

A yacht's engineering journey does not end at launch. From stability booklets and technical documentation to safety and emergency planning, and long-term consultancy services, the process spans the vessel's entire lifecycle.

This holistic approach demonstrates that engineering extends beyond the production phase into ongoing operation.

In maritime projects, engineering is often shaped by choices made out of sight. Yet these choices ultimately determine a yacht's long-term performance.

SEA

DESIGN



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SPECIAL REPORT

A Sectoral Reading

of the Turkish Yacht Building Industry

in 2025



Special Feature by
Aslı SAĞBİLGE

In recent years, Türkiye has demonstrated steadily increasing visibility in the international yacht-building market, supported by shipyards operating across a wide range of scales. From large-tonnage, fully custom superyacht projects to highly engineered productions in the 30–40-metre range with strong brand value, this broad spectrum reflects the diversity of Türkiye's yacht-building ecosystem.

This special feature has been prepared based on editorially verified and publication-approved information obtained from shipyards operating in Istanbul, the Aegean, and the Mediterranean regions. The content aims to present publicly available project statuses, new launches, and ongoing construction activities as of 2025.

Prepared for Boot Düsseldorf, this special issue seeks to convey the current production pace and project diversity of Türkiye's yacht-building sector through verified data and an editorial perspective.



ISTANBUL REGION

2025 has been recorded as a balanced production year for RMK Yachts, marked by the simultaneous development of new launches and the design-driven repositioning of an existing platform.

LIVIA 72

72 m – New launch (Monaco Yacht Show 2025)

LIVIA 50

50 m – New launch (Monaco Yacht Show 2025)

Orca 58

58 m – Redesigned





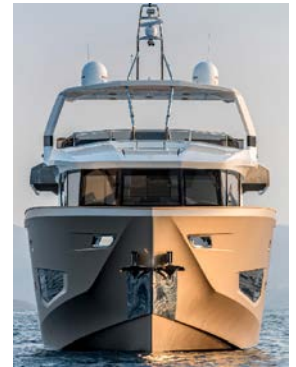
Throughout 2025, Numarine sustained its strong production capacity in the series-built explorer segment, supported by high delivery volumes and a build schedule extending into 2026.

Explorer Series – Delivered

40MXP Mitan
40MXP Miouch
37XP Orpheus
32XP Ray
26XP Lizay
26XP Totoro
30XP Tuccini

Explorer Series – Ongoing

27XP – New Launch
30XP (HN3–4) – Under Construction
26XP (HN30) – Under Construction
27XP (HN1–4) – Under Construction
37XP (HN19) – Under Construction
40MXP (HN20) – Under Construction



TURQUOISE

YACHTS

Throughout 2025, Turquoise Yachts sustained a long-term and consistent production line focused on large-scale superyacht projects.

M/Y Nymphéas
78.9 m – Delivered

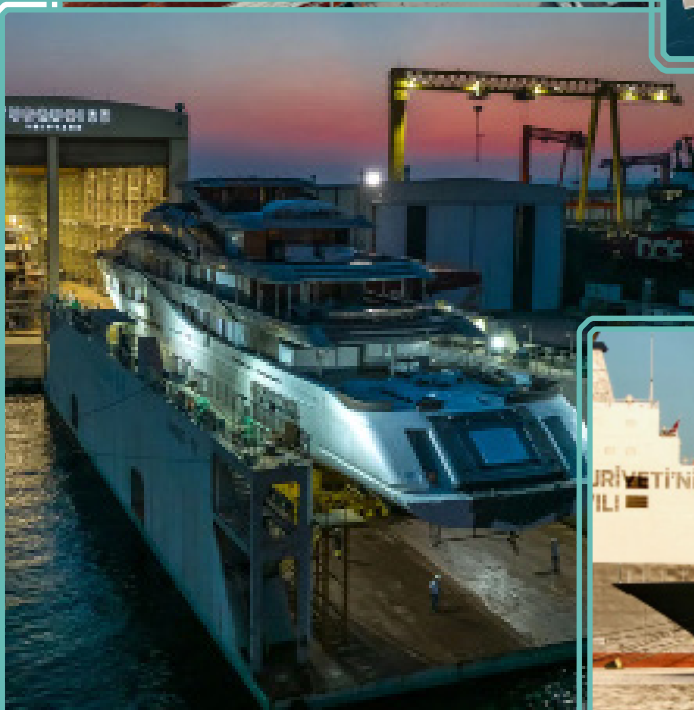
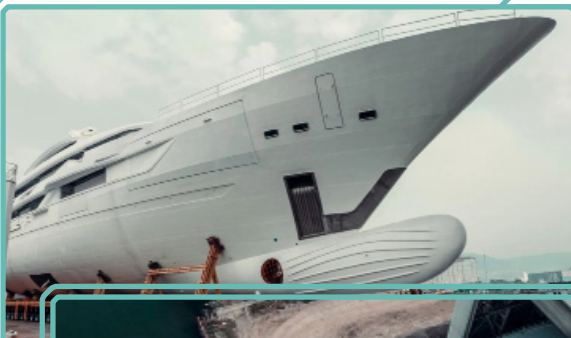
Project Vento
87 m – Under Construction

Project Arrow
76.3 m – Under Construction

S/Y Project Wildcat
42 m – Under Construction

Project BRAVO
80 m – Under Construction

Project Rafale
81.3 m – Under Construction





DUNYA YACHTS

In 2025, Dunya Yachts maintained its position in the superyacht segment with a portfolio consisting entirely of large-scale, fully custom projects.

Project Faith

88 m – Under Construction

DY009

47 m – Delivered

DY010

48 m – Under Construction

DY006

80 m – Under Construction





By managing both deliveries and ongoing builds in 2025, SES Yachts maintained a diversified production profile within the mid-size segment.

Dark Sky

25.8 m - Delivered

GX42

42 m - Under Construction

Other projects

26-42 m range - Under Construction



fabbro

yachts

In 2025, Dunya Yachts maintained its position in the superyacht segment with a portfolio consisting entirely of large-scale, fully custom projects.

Project Faith

88 m - Under Construction

DY009

47 m - Delivered

DY010

48 m - Under Construction

DY006

80 m - Under Construction



AIATA

With two new models, the Sunfinder series expanded AIATA's product portfolio.

Sunfinder 50

World premiere — Boot Düsseldorf 2026

Sunfinder 38

World premiere — Boot Düsseldorf 2026





BODRUM REGION

In 2025, Ege Yat demonstrated a balanced production tempo through the simultaneous execution of projects at different scales.

Project Carmen
37.3 m – Delivered

66 m Superyacht
66 m – Under Construction

41 m Motor Yacht
41 m – Under Construction



ANTALYA REGION

For Ares Yachts, 2025 was recorded as a transition year focused on expanding the product range and increasing scale rather than on deliveries

Simena

62 m – Final Outfitting Stage

Spitfire

~50 m – Under Construction

Atlas

~54 m – Concept Project





AvA Yachts

AvA Yachts presented a production approach that combines series-built discipline with a semi-custom philosophy in the expedition yacht segment.

M/Y Voyage One
26.2 m – Under construction
Kando85
25.7 m – Under construction
Kando110
33.5 m – Under construction





For Nebula Yachts, 2025 was a balanced year marked by a project nearing delivery alongside a parallel investment in a larger-scale build.

Amanda
57 m — Approaching Delivery

Marimba
64 m — Under Construction





Orhan Torlak

Chairman of Tortur Denizcilik

Balance Rooted in Expertise: Tortur Denizcilik x Z-Gyro

Positioned as an engineering-driven maritime organization with roots dating back to the 19th century—and continuing yacht production under the Senamare brand—Tortur Denizcilik brings a strong culture of hands-on manufacturing experience. This production-based know-how remains a key reference point in the company's approach to technology and equipment selection today.



As of 2025, Tortur Denizcilik has taken on the role of Türkiye distributor for Z-Gyro stabilization systems. Rather than viewing this partnership as a strategic pivot, the company frames it as a natural extension of its long-established technical philosophy. We spoke with Orhan Torlak, Chairman of Tortur Denizcilik, about Z-Gyro's engineering details, performance across different sea conditions, and its impact on the sector.

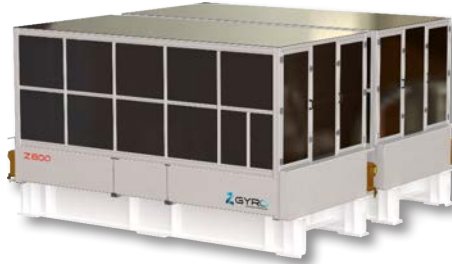
Tortur and Senamare have a long-standing production culture. How does this culture act as a filter when selecting new technologies?

For us, new technology must be strategic; it should not disrupt existing operations, it must be proven, economical, future-proof, and must not introduce risk.

In your first experience with Z-Gyro, which technical feature impressed you the most?

What stood out most was that Z-Gyro is produced with advanced technology and meets expectations at a very high level—around 90%. Its very low maintenance costs are also a significant advantage.

“Technology is only meaningful if it strengthens operations.”



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What is a detail often overlooked in stabilizers but critical to real user experience, and where does Z-Gyro stand in this regard?

In gyro stabilizers, a commonly overlooked yet decisive factor is how the rotational movement around the axis is naturally and controllably managed. This rotation results from the flywheel's momentum interacting with wave-induced roll motion, bent at 90 degrees to create oscillation. This natural process synchronizes stabilizing torque perfectly with wave rhythm, delivering smooth, delay-free comfort. Mariners tend to prefer the calm, relaxing roll reduction of gyro systems over the more abrupt behavior of fin stabilizers.

“True comfort comes from systems that work without being noticed.”

In small and mid-size vessels, air/water cooling, power demand, and weight are critical. How would you explain Z-Gyro's advantage in this segment?

Z-Gyro provides vibration-free, quiet, and exceptionally smooth cruising. That clarity alone summarizes the product's position.

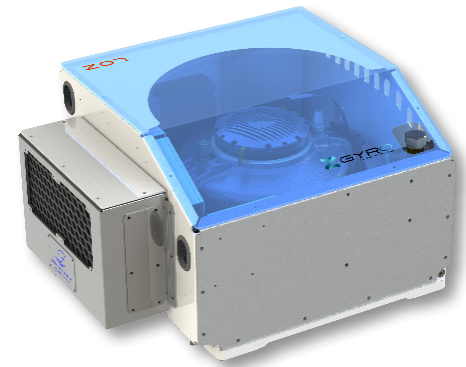
Z-Gyro's torque-momentum balance stands out in technical documentation. How does this translate into real-world roll behavior?

In Z-Gyro stabilizers, torque-momentum balance dynamically defines roll behavior according to wave frequency. High momentum is effective against long-period, low-frequency waves, while high torque enables rapid response to short-period, sudden waves. Z-Gyro synchronizes momentum—derived from torque speed—with wave rhythm; high torque captures sudden roll changes and neutralizes roll velocity without delay.

“A well-designed system does not disrupt the shipyard's rhythm.”

Installation is often invisible to the end user but critical. What advantages does Z-Gyro offer shipyards during integration?

The main advantage lies in its compact internal mounting design and modular installation structure. This allows fast integration into new-build or refit projects without disrupting shipyard workflows. The absence of external seawater connections or hydraulic hoses saves both time and labor.



Türkiye features very different sea conditions—from the Aegean to Marmara and the Black Sea. How does Z-Gyro perform across this geography?

In the Aegean, short-period meltem waves highlight the importance of high torque; in the Black Sea, long-period storm-induced rolls emphasize high momentum. In Marmara's variable current structure, Z-Gyro operates with 96% consistency, while deviation during Bosphorus transits under turbulence remains as low as 0.8°

What is Tortur Denizcilik's approach to service, spare parts, and technical support?

As an authorized distributor, we provide a comprehensive service network, original spare parts stock, and remote technical monitoring. From turnkey installation to annual maintenance, full support is ensured. Emergency service requests across Türkiye are addressed within 24 hours.

From an industry insider's perspective, how do you see stabilizer solutions evolving in Türkiye over the next five years?

Between 2025 and 2030, gyro stabilizer solutions in Türkiye are expected to gain momentum alongside 20–25% growth in yacht and commercial vessel demand. Refit projects and rising comfort expectations will be the main drivers.

Finally, how has your long maritime career shaped your insight into this partnership?

My years in maritime operations have provided deep insight into anticipating operational challenges and developing practical solutions. Durability, efficiency, and long-term performance have been decisive factors in equipment selection.

“Comfort is no longer an option—it is a standard.”

Finally, how has your long maritime career shaped your insight into this partnership?

My years in maritime operations have provided deep insight into anticipating operational challenges and developing practical solutions. Durability, efficiency, and long-term performance have been decisive factors in equipment selection.



Some systems succeed by becoming almost invisible as they work. That is where true achievement begins. Tortur Denizcilik's partnership with Z-Gyro goes beyond introducing a new product to the market; it reflects a long-term approach that turns comfort at sea into an engineering principle.

ARES Yachts: A Superyacht Culture Forged by Discipline



"Years of defence and commercial shipbuilding have shaped our mindset. Precision is not optional. It is fundamental."

In the world of luxury yachting, some brands do more than build yachts. They establish a consistent and sustainable production philosophy. The deeply rooted manufacturing discipline that has made ARES a global reference in defence and commercial shipbuilding has now been carried into the superyacht segment with the same level of precision and control.

As one of Türkiye's most integrated shipyards, equipped with advanced production capabilities, ARES represents a culture where craftsmanship, design, engineering and innovation are aligned along a single strategic vision. This culture does not emerge by chance. It is the result of decades of accumulated experience and a strong commitment to engineering excellence.

I wanted to observe this culture first-hand within the international atmosphere of boot Düsseldorf. The story of ARES extends beyond that of a conventional shipyard. It reflects a conscious transformation shaped by a strong family legacy and reinforced by modern production methodologies. What emerges is an engineering driven language of aesthetics and performance that speaks confidently to the global market.

To better understand the production philosophy shaping the future of ARES Yachts and the vision behind the brand, I spoke with Kerem Kalafatoğlu, Board Member of ARES Shipyard.

This interview offers a clear perspective on how ARES positions itself within the superyacht industry and how its production mindset defines its identity.

"Managing all processes under one roof minimizes the margin of error."

Kerem Kalafatoğlu
Board Member, ARES Shipyard

ARES is internationally recognized for its strong engineering culture. After transferring years of production discipline into the luxury yacht segment, what do you see as the most distinctive element of this corporate culture?

At ARES, engineering is not simply a technical capability. It is a corporate responsibility. Years of experience in defence and commercial shipbuilding have shaped a mindset where error is not an option. This same discipline ensures that aesthetics and comfort in our yachts are always underpinned by uncompromising engineering rigor.

Your structure brings together design, engineering, composite production and interior craftsmanship under one roof. This goes far beyond conventional production models in the sector. How does this integrated structure reflect on the quality you deliver?

In many shipyards, different disciplines are managed by separate teams in different locations. At ARES, we have brought this fragmented structure together as much as possible under one roof. This allows us to maintain a controlled and predictable production process.

Managing all stages from design to interior craftsmanship within the same facility significantly reduces the margin for error. At the same time, it ensures continuity in quality control. Instant feedback at every stage allows potential issues to be resolved early. This ultimately creates a lasting sense of confidence in the final yacht.

You have transferred your technical expertise into the superyacht world, carrying ARES long standing meticulousness into a new segment. How would you define the signature your production philosophy leaves on the yacht market?

I would define the ARES signature as an uncompromising attention to details that are not immediately visible. Structural solutions and system integration are just as important to us as exterior design. I firmly believe that this meticulous approach ensures our yachts retain the same sense of quality not only at first glance, but also many years later.



Projects such as SPITFIRE, which require hybrid solutions and advanced engineering, clearly reveal your research and development perspective. How does this innovative approach affect the organization internally?

Innovative projects like SIMENA and SPITFIRE have a strong motivational impact, particularly among younger engineers and designers. These projects allow us to experience the standards of the future today. Our teams know they are not simply building a yacht. They are contributing to the future of production itself. This strengthens creative energy and a strong sense of ownership within the company.

Your integrated facilities in Antalya allow you to control many processes from supply chain management to quality control. How does this structure reflect on your brand strength?

Our integrated production structure provides not only high capacity, but also full end to end control. Managing every process within the same facility from the earliest stage of a project to final delivery is the main reason we are able to maintain a consistent quality standard across different projects.

This consistency directly reinforces trust in the ARES brand. Today, ARES can be defined as a shipyard that delivers on its promises, on time and at the expected level of quality, while continuing to stand behind its products long after delivery.

"Operating defence, commercial and luxury yacht construction under one roof creates a strong sense of trust."

Operating defence, commercial and luxury yacht construction under one roof is not something every brand can achieve. What kind of competitive advantage does this diversity create for ARES?

This structure creates a clear sense of trust on the client side. A shipyard that has proven itself in military and commercial projects is naturally perceived as more solid and reliable when it comes to superyacht construction. Our clients know that every yacht delivered by ARES is backed by decades of engineering culture and a robust production infrastructure.

At the same time, managing different disciplines within the same organization provides a significant knowledge transfer advantage. The discipline and quality control sensitivity developed in military and commercial projects are directly reflected in our superyacht builds.

Today's global clientele demands not only a yacht, but also reliability, sustainability and a long-term relationship. How do you approach these expectations?

Today's superyacht owner is not simply purchasing a yacht. They are looking for a reliable partner. This is an approach we have embraced for many years at ARES Shipyard. Our Integrated Logistics Support department ensures that every vessel delivered from our shipyard is supported worldwide with the same level of training, service and attention. For us, this is not an additional service. It is a natural extension of the ARES quality philosophy.

International boat shows are also platforms where brands express their character. How will ARES Yachts position itself in 2026?

We see 2026 as a defining year for ARES Yachts on the international stage. Our first superyacht built under the ARES Yachts brand, the 62-meter sailing superyacht SIMENA, will be at the centre of this positioning.

SIMENA will be presented to the public for the first time at the Palma International Boat Show, followed by the Monaco Yacht Show. We believe SIMENA will represent in the clearest way the production philosophy and brand character of ARES Yachts.

"2026 will be a defining year for ARES Yachts on the international stage."

Superyachts of the future are shaped not only by design, but also by production philosophy. Which approach do you believe will gain value in the coming years?

We believe the future of superyachts will be shaped by a more conscious and responsible production mindset. Energy efficiency, correct material selection and modern propulsion systems integrated with hybrid solutions have become essential components of a high-quality superyacht.

Final Note

As Kerem Kalafatoğlu emphasizes, ARES Yachts builds superyachts that meet today's expectations while being shaped by the standards of tomorrow.



Interview by Aslı Sağbilge

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GLASS, LUXURY, AND DESIGN

in Yachts with SAKEN

Founded in 2009, SAKEN has drawn attention by combining “glass”—an elegant yet challenging material—with industrial design discipline and traditional craftsmanship. Today, the brand stands out with bespoke projects ranging from superyachts to luxury residences.

In this special interview, we spoke with Faik Kale, one of SAKEN’s founders and the Owner and Design Director of Saken Design, about the rising role of glass in the luxury yacht world, the brand’s approach shaped at the intersection of art, design, and custom production, and its international vision.



Faik Kale
One of SAKEN’s Founders &
Owner and Design Director

“It creates an output process that brings the product and the artwork together.”



AKYACHT Project Victorius

SAKEN's story is quite unique. Where does the combination of industrial design and glass craftsmanship in yachting position your brand today?

We can describe it as a form of work rooted in interdisciplinary collaboration and driven by innovation. While design seeks to answer questions related to needs through products, glass art represents a journey of creating works by blending the artist's relationship with the material, production techniques, emotions, and the craftsmanship refined over time.

Saken brings together the concept of the "product," which is the output of industrial product design, and the concept of the "artwork," which is the output of glass art. In doing so, it transforms a form imbued with emotion into an object, creating a unique output process we can call an "artwork product." This approach positions Saken within a niche segment.

Sarp Yachts Project La Passion



"Glass provides a powerful response to the emotional quest of luxury yacht owners and designers."

Superyacht owners and designers are seeking personalized art and materials. What role does glass play in this new understanding of luxury?

This quest is not new; since the beginning of existence, humans have desired beauty, difference, and what belongs solely to them. What makes glass special is glass itself. It is neither fully solid nor fully liquid; it has a living character.

Glass production does not tolerate haste—it requires precision, care, and mastery. It is a material in love with light, and the process of turning it into an object gains meaning over time.

Glass embraces aesthetics as a form and knows no limits during its shaping process. With this quality, it sits at the very center of the concept of luxury.

AKYACHT Project Victorious



"Glass creates the atmosphere and identity of yacht interiors."

Beyond aesthetics, what kind of spatial impact makes glass decisive in yacht interiors?

Glass absorbs light and spreads it into its surroundings as form, reflection, and movement. It gives light a new body—shading it, energizing it, and transforming it into a visual effect.

When placed in a space as a wall sconce, a chandelier, a bar counter, or a sculptural object, glass delivers a magical final touch to the soul of that space.

For this reason, glass represents the moment when design is completed and the identity of the space becomes clear.



"You cannot hang a chandelier in a yacht the same way you do in a residence."

International clients may perceive custom production as 'high risk.' How does SAKEN manage this perception?

Having started my career in the yacht sector in 1999 as a technician and worked in various production roles until 2015, I can confidently say that know-how related to yacht production is critically important.

Yachts are not merely living spaces; they are constantly tested by the energy of seas and oceans. The fragile nature of glass creates a serious technical responsibility at this point.

Therefore, it is not enough to transform glass into an aesthetic product; it must also be proven safe. We toughen and laminate the glass and install it using flexible connection systems.

In the more than one hundred projects we have completed since our founding, we have not experienced a single safety issue.

"Each glass piece is truly 'unique.'"

How does SAKEN's combination of craftsmanship with high-tolerance production standards make a difference in custom projects?

Glass production requires working with a semi-living material. While the final result is always very close to the design, it differs through subtle nuances.

This difference gives each product its own unique character. Glass itself is not a rare material; however, the rarity of artists and workshops capable of working it in this way makes each piece truly "unique."



AKYACHT Project Victorious

“Saken becomes a sought-after brand rather than merely a visible one for international yacht designers.”

How do you evaluate SAKEN’s growing international visibility in yachting?

Glass art follows the traces of ancient knowledge. True mastery requires many years of dedication. This limited production capacity makes the resulting works valuable.

For this reason, foreign designers increasingly prefer products that carry the mark of this limited mastery. Saken becomes a brand that is sought after rather than simply visible.

The most in-demand product groups are lighting elements and installations.

“A 500-year-old technique comes to life in superyacht design.”



Sarp Yachts Project La Passion

Your sculptural works born from the interaction of glass and light are striking. What is the most innovative approach you have developed for yachts?

In its lighting designs, Saken uses the casting glass method, one of the most challenging techniques in glass production. With roots dating back to the 15th century, this technique produces sculptural forms when combined with a modern design approach.

Each object comes to life through mastery, patience, and an artistic vision.

For this reason, glass represents the moment when design is completed and the identity of the space becomes clear.

“Glass creates the atmosphere and identity of yacht interiors.”



AES Yacht Project Victoria

How do you see the role of glass in superyacht design in the coming years?

The role of glass is steadily increasing. However, this development is directly linked to the visibility and production capacity of artistic glass manufacturers.

Strong communication with designers will enable more original and high-quality glass applications to become widespread in the sector.

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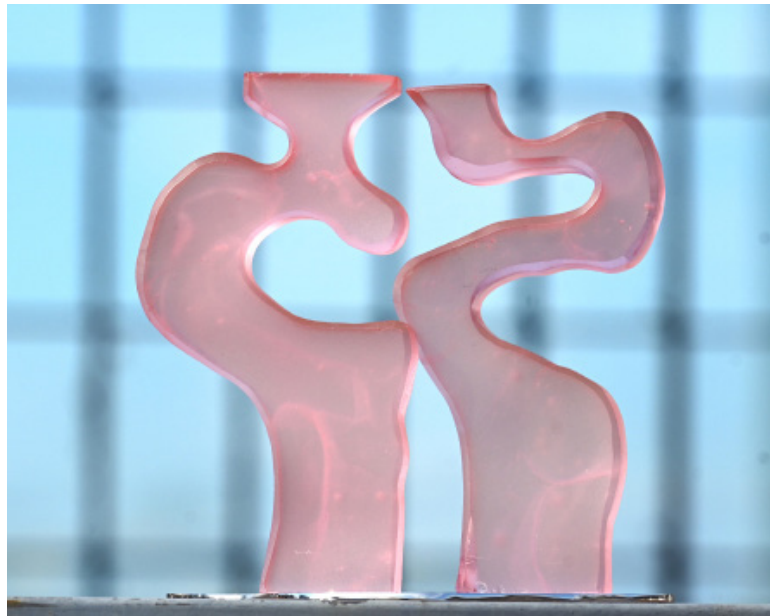
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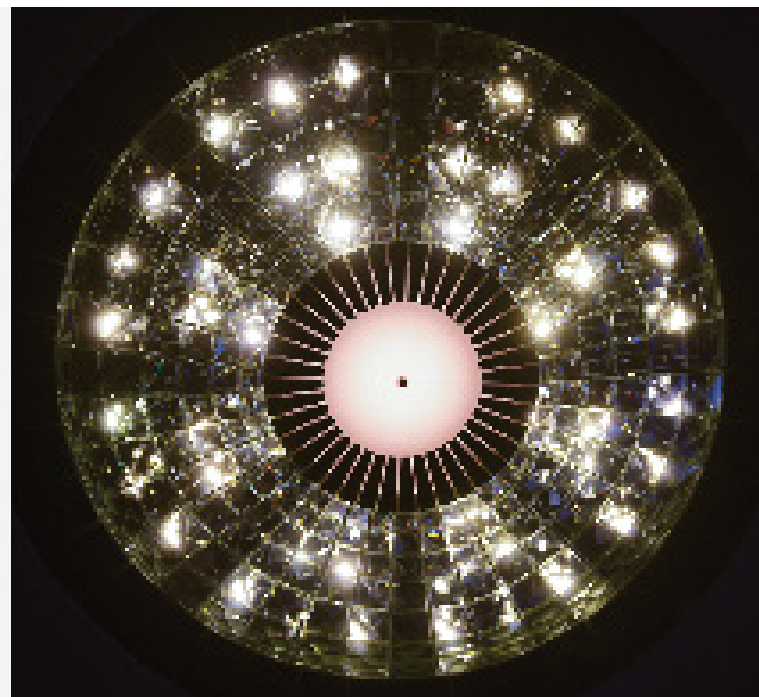
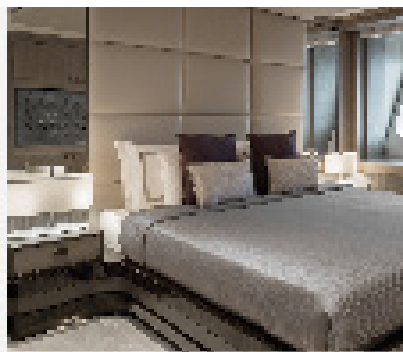
What message would you like to highlight specifically for Boot Düsseldorf?

In this segment, where series production and semi-custom yachts stand out, I believe collaborations with artistic glass manufacturers create significant value."

Therefore, my message to companies exhibiting their products at the fair is that increasing collaborations with brands producing artistic glass will generate great value.

For yacht builders who want to make a difference, such collaborations provide strong and positive returns.

This interview demonstrates the multi-layered role of glass in superyacht design-from aesthetics to safety-through SAKEN's production approach.



Turkish Ship and Yacht Sector Ends 2025 with Record Results

The Turkish ship and yacht sector concluded 2025 with a strong export performance and high value-added production capacity. According to assessments by the Ship, Yacht and Services Exporters' Association (GYHİB), the sector sustained its steady growth despite intensifying global competition and ranked among the industries that closed the year with record figures.



Strong Growth in High Value-Added Exports

Mustafa Gültepe, Chairman of the Turkish Exporters Assembly (TİM), announced that the sector reached export levels of approximately USD 2 billion during the January–November period of 2025. Noting an increase of more than 15 percent compared to the same period last year, Gültepe emphasized that achieving double-digit growth in a year when overall exports expanded by only 3.5 percent clearly demonstrates the importance of value-added production that brings together technology, engineering, design, and advanced manufacturing capabilities. He underlined that this success represents not only an economic gain but also the result of the value placed on knowledge, design, and innovation.

Top-Tier Performance in Export Value per Kilogram

Cem Seven, Chairman of the Board of GYHİB, drew attention to the sector's export value per kilogram, which remains well above the Turkish average. He stated that the average export value per kilogram is around USD 25 for special-purpose vessels and approximately USD 50 for mega yachts. Seven noted that deliveries in 2025 of ship and yacht projects whose construction began two to four years earlier helped exports reach the USD 2 billion level. He added that even when naval vessels, repair and maintenance services, and boats produced in free zones are excluded, the sector still recorded a record-breaking year.

Seven also recalled that efforts to enhance the sector's international visibility continued intensively throughout 2025. National participation organizations at Nor-Shipping in Norway, Neva in St. Petersburg, and Europort in the Netherlands strengthened the global positioning of the Turkish ship and yacht industry.



Meanwhile, the sector faced several structural challenges while sustaining its growth. Inflation and exchange-rate imbalances affecting labor costs, the removal of VAT exemptions for boats under 24 meters, the reduced effectiveness of export foreign-exchange repatriation supports due to long construction periods, and new regulations complicating access to finance emerged as key factors pressuring competitiveness. In addition,

India's rising strategy—supported by state incentives in shipbuilding and investments attracted from South Korean shipyards—is expected to further intensify global competition in the period ahead.

Despite these challenges, 2025 was recorded as a year in which the Turkish ship and yacht sector consolidated its position in global markets through its high value-added production structure, engineering strength, and design-oriented approach. The sector is entering 2026 with both a strong order portfolio and increased international visibility.

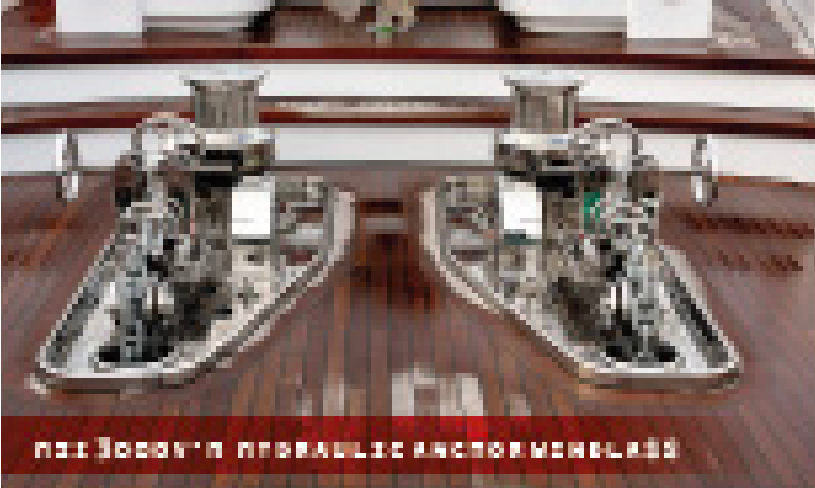


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AKYACHT

Holds Steel Cutting Ceremony for Project NB012

AKYACHT, one of the prominent shipyards in the Turkish superyacht construction sector, has held the steel cutting ceremony for its new superyacht project, NB012. With this ceremony, the project has officially moved from the design and engineering phase into the production stage.

Planned to exceed 120 metres in length, Project NB012 will become one of the largest yachts ever built by the shipyard once completed. Featuring a steel hull and aluminium superstructure, the superyacht is expected to elevate AKYACHT's engineering and production capabilities in large-tonnage projects to a new level.

The project involves international design and engineering teams, and the steel cutting ceremony has once again drawn the global yachting industry's attention to Türkiye. Further details regarding the delivery schedule are expected to be announced at a later stage.



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Türkiye's 65th Marina

Sets Sail in Gazipaşa



Türkiye has added a magnificent new star to its yachting tourism portfolio. Gazipaşa, Antalya's still-undiscovered paradise, has opened its doors to the global yachting community with Gold Marina. With a capacity of 208 berths, this ultra-modern facility is poised to reshape Eastern Mediterranean routes.

The opening ceremony—where luxury investment met maritime vision—hosted the Minister of Transport and Infrastructure, Abdulkadir Uraloğlu, alongside prominent regional figures and industry leaders. The strong turnout reflected the excitement already surrounding this new destination.

Gazipaşa Gold Marina: Transforming a Route

The inauguration of Gold Marina stands as a clear example of Türkiye's growing ambition in the maritime sector. As Minister Uraloğlu noted:

"This project will turn Gazipaşa into a strategic hub for international yachting tourism."

Beyond accommodating 208 yachts, the marina has been designed as a vibrant social and lifestyle center for yacht owners and visitors alike.

Minister Uraloğlu also shared striking figures highlighting Türkiye's maritime momentum:

"We have increased the number of marinas from 41 to 65 and expanded berth capacity from 8,500 to 26,000, significantly strengthening our marine tourism infrastructure. Having five ports in the world container ports league and ranking ninth globally in shipbuilding demonstrate the national strength behind prestigious projects such as Gold Marina."



Abdulkadir Uraloğlu
Minister of Transport and Infrastructure

A Next-Generation Stop on the Blue Voyage

Gazipaşa Gold Marina goes beyond being a safe harbor; it is envisioned as a hub of experiences. Yacht owners and crews will benefit from state-of-the-art maintenance services while enjoying the region's tranquil atmosphere and pristine natural beauty. With a hotel and additional facilities scheduled for completion in the near future, the marina is set to become an essential stop for global yachts cruising the Mediterranean.

By joining Türkiye's growing network of standout marinas across the Aegean and Mediterranean, Gold Marina opens a luxurious and comfortable gateway for seafarers to discover the unspoiled beauty of Gazipaşa.

Begüm Yachting Expands Its Portfolio: Begüm Maritime Consultancy Opens Its Doors in Istanbul

Begüm Maritime Consultancy, the new advisory branch of Begüm Group, has officially launched its operations with an opening ceremony held in Istanbul. The event took place on 22 November 2025 at Raffles Hotel – Zorlu Center and brought together leading representatives of the Turkish maritime sector, including flag administrations, classification societies, chamber of commerce officials and maritime NGOs.



Begüm Doğulu, Founder and CEO of the company, stated in her opening remarks that the new consultancy will transfer Begüm Yachting's extensive experience into the advisory field, offering services in regulatory compliance, international flag registration, marina and shipyard investments, as well as newbuild yacht orders and refit contract management.

Begüm Maritime Consultancy aims to provide comprehensive local and global advisory services across a wide spectrum—from preparing new yacht order and refit agreements, to managing feasibility studies, permitting and licensing processes for marina and shipyard investments. Its services will also cover Turkish flag transition, charter licensing, international flag registration and change of flag procedures, as well as the management of transit and customs operations and the recovery of maritime claims.

Founded in 1997, Begüm Yachting is a well-established company offering agency and charter services along the Turkish coast, with a broad portfolio including brokerage, yacht management, agency operations and shipyard services.

**BEGÜM DOĞULU – TAMER KIRAN**

Building on this long-standing infrastructure and expertise, the newly established Begüm Maritime Consultancy aims to support yacht owners and investors in yacht operations management and regulatory-administrative processes. This step is seen as part of Begüm Group's strategy to strengthen its position in the yachting sector by expanding into consultancy and corporate services.

By focusing on complex legal, administrative and international compliance processes, Begüm Maritime Consultancy intends to become a notable player both in Türkiye and the global market.

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New Benchmarks in Marina Management: The D-Marin Example

Among the busy agenda of the Abu Dhabi International Boat Show, one of the highlights this year was the announcement of the Abu Dhabi Maritime Awards. Considered a key reference program for marina operations in the MENAT region, D-Marin stood out by winning a total of seven awards across four marinas in Türkiye and the United Arab Emirates, demonstrating a strong regional performance.

The awards are presented in the "Outstanding Marina" categories, covering core aspects of marina management such as customer experience, sustainability, innovation, health & safety, employer excellence, and operational standards. A notable addition to this year's program was the introduction of the "Outstanding Emerging Marina" category, designed to recognize facilities with high development potential in the region.



What do the evaluation notes reveal?

According to the program organizers, key evaluation criteria included customer engagement, feedback management, needs analysis, and a systematic approach to building long-term loyalty. This emphasis demonstrates that D-Marin maintains a standardized, premium experience focus across its operations in different countries.

D-Marin Commercial Director Dean Smith emphasized the company's goal of delivering the same level of service across all locations, ensuring that guests enjoy consistently high standards regardless of which marina they choose.

Focusing on Türkiye, Can Akaltan, D-Marin Türkiye Country Director, highlighted the team achievements at Turgutreis, Göcek, and Didim in the areas of innovation, sustainability, and customer excellence.

In the UAE, Selçuk Balcı, D-Marin UAE General Manager, underlined that Marsa Al Arab has quickly evolved into an exclusive destination thanks to its unique location and tailored services.

D Marin

Turkish marinas in the spotlight

The results also highlight the level Turkish marina facilities have reached in international competition.

- D-Marin Turgutreis received Gold in Sustainability and Silver in Health & Safety
- D-Marin Didim was awarded Gold in Customer Experience and Silver in the Outstanding Marina category
- D-Marin Göcek earned Gold in Innovation and Silver in Customer Experience

This distribution confirms that the marina management approach that has developed along the Aegean coast in recent years is being validated by international institutions.

Signals of regional expansion

On the UAE side, D-Marin Marsa Al Arab received a Gold award in the "Outstanding Emerging Marina" category. Located adjacent to Dubai's iconic Jumeirah Burj Al Arab, the marina has strengthened its position as a potential new luxury hub in the region with this recognition.



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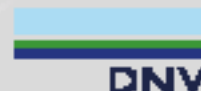
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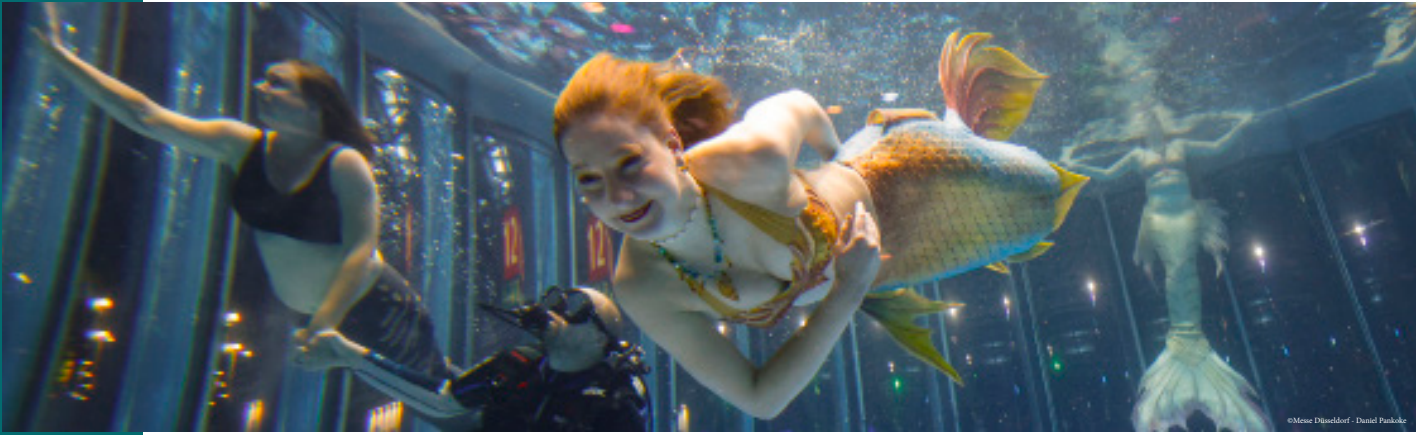
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BOOT DÜSSELDORF 2026

boot The Turkish Yachting Season Opens on the Show Floor

As the world's largest indoor yacht show, Boot Düsseldorf once again stands as the first major meeting point shaping the direction of the 2026 season. A platform where new projects, partnerships, and market perspectives take form, the show also serves as the starting line of the year for the global yachting industry.

Opening its doors from 17 to 25 January, Boot Düsseldorf spreads across 16 exhibition halls, offering far more than a showcase of yachts. It functions as a multi-layered meeting space where the industry takes its pulse, tests emerging trends, and establishes the season's first professional connections. From superyachts to series-production motor yachts, sailing yachts to tenders and RIBs, and from marine equipment to water sports, its wide-ranging content makes the show unique on a global scale.



The Starting Point of the Season for the Yachting Industry

Boot Düsseldorf's importance for the sector stems largely from its position on the calendar. As the first major European show of the year, the contacts established here extend well beyond visibility. Early signals of order activity, feedback on new models, and demand for technical solutions often shape the rest of the season.

In this sense, Boot Düsseldorf creates a strategic environment not only for builders but also for design studios, engineering teams, equipment manufacturers, and service providers. Its visitor profile includes not only end users, but also professional buyers, distributors, and decision-makers, making the show a platform with strong commercial impact.

Key Themes of 2026

The content of Boot Düsseldorf 2026 clearly reflects the core issues currently shaping the yachting industry. Sustainability sits at the center of these themes. Alternative propulsion systems, more efficient hull forms, responsible material use, and advanced energy management solutions are among the most prominent topics throughout the exhibition.





In parallel, technical solutions and engineering details have become as decisive as aesthetics. Electric and hybrid systems, next-generation equipment, smart control mechanisms, and technologies enhancing user experience are central to many brands' presentations. Dedicated areas focusing on propulsion systems, navigation technologies, and advanced equipment solutions rank among the most closely followed sections by industry professionals.

Complementing this technical focus, specialized areas such as the Refit Center concentrate on the renewal, modernization, and performance enhancement of existing yachts. From structural reinforcement and system upgrades to energy-efficiency solutions and technical conversion projects, these themes make the refit area one of the show's key destinations for both yacht owners and professionals.

Another defining feature of the fair is its ability to bring water sports and maritime lifestyle culture together with yachting under one roof. From diving to surfing, paddleboarding to wakeboarding, this broad spectrum highlights that the relationship with the sea extends well beyond the yacht itself.

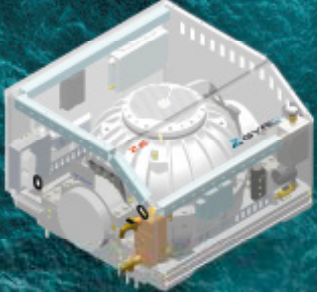


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The Turkish Yachting Industry on the Ground

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A Showcase That Sets the Course

More than a venue for displaying yachts, Boot Düsseldorf stands as a reference point that makes the industry's direction, pace, and priorities visible. The outlook for the 2026 season indicates that the yachting industry is evolving toward a more technical, more sustainable, and more integrated approach.

At the first major international gathering of the season, the Turkish yachting industry is present on the show floor with a broad perspective encompassing production, engineering, design, and service infrastructure. This presence is set to play a defining role in shaping business models and market trends in the period ahead.

And as every year, in short: the course of the season will once again be drawn in Düsseldorf.



Metstrade²⁰₂₅

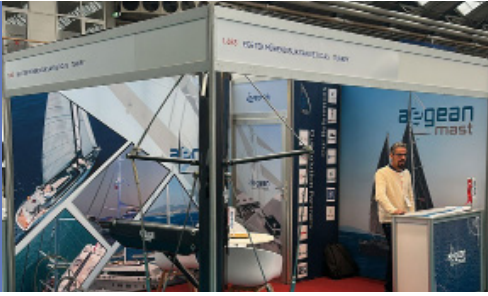
Notes from the Show Floor



The world's largest marine equipment exhibition, METSTRADE 2025, was held at RAI Amsterdam from 18–20 November. Showcasing the latest innovations in marine equipment and marina technologies, the exhibition drew strong interest from international visitors, with Turkish companies standing out through their advanced engineering solutions and sustainability-focused products.

Yat Haber Türkiye, Türkiye's only yachting magazine regularly present at international events, was on site at METSTRADE 2025 with its English special edition. Being present at the show alongside Turkish companies created a valuable point of contact for closely following new products and global industry trends directly on the show floor.

Perspectives from the Exhibitors



Ege Tek Engineering experienced a more efficient exhibition compared to the previous year, showcasing demo masts at METSTRADE 2025. The demo masts on display allowed visitors to experience the company's engineering approach and production quality firsthand. Solutions developed with a focus on lightness, durability, and technical precision were among the key aspects attracting international attention. Throughout the show, the Ege Tek Engineering team strengthened existing relationships while holding important meetings aimed at new collaborations.

SEAPOW Electrical Systems presented its range of yacht-oriented solutions, including shore power converters, isolation transformers, hybrid power systems, and iso-boost transformers. Throughout the exhibition, technical solutions focused on safe and stable power transfer—capable of adapting to different grid conditions—stood out. The performance and integration capabilities of energy-efficient hybrid power systems in yacht applications attracted particular interest from industry professionals visiting the stand.



Data Hidrolik described METSTRADE 2025 as a productive event where it once again demonstrated its manufacturing strength and engineering capability on an international scale. Showcasing deck equipment and steering systems, the company both reinforced face-to-face connections with existing partners and expanded its business network through new contacts. These interactions are expected to provide fresh momentum, while Data Hidrolik's role as a Supporting Partner at The Boat Builder Awards 2025 was highlighted as a strong indicator of its commitment to the industry. The company emphasized its satisfaction in reflecting its dedication to engineering, sustainability, and innovation on a global platform.



For **OTOSTECH**, METSTRADE 2025 proved to be an efficient meeting point, particularly for establishing new customer relationships in the European market. Being among the limited number of companies able to offer composite model, mold, and product processes holistically under one roof was positively received by visitors. In addition, the integration of next-generation production technologies such as the 3D Caracol robotic printer further reinforced OTOSTECH's solution-oriented and forward-looking approach.



Kaya Ropes exhibited its product range at METSTRADE 2025, including yacht and sailing ropes, as well as performance, dinghy, and mooring lines. The interest shown in its products and the new connections established during the show provided valuable feedback, strengthening the brand's position in international markets. While reinforcing relationships with existing partners, the Kaya Ropes team also laid the groundwork for new collaborations with professionals from different regions. The brand described METSTRADE 2025 as a productive meeting where it had the opportunity to communicate its quality- and performance-driven product philosophy to a broader global audience while closely following market trends.



METSTRADE 2025 served as a key meeting point where the engineering strength, product capabilities, and international positioning of Turkish marine companies became clearly visible on the show floor. These brief notes from the exhibition reflect not only the products on display, but also the connections formed, partnerships developed, and signals pointing toward the future direction of the industry.

As Yat Haber Türkiye, we will continue to follow and report from the field, tracing the presence of Turkish companies across the global marine scene.



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The Global Yachting Industry's Heart Beat in Istanbul with SST'25



Superyacht Summit Türkiye (SST), the Eastern Mediterranean's leading superyacht event, opened its doors for the third time on 11–12 November 2025. This year, the atmosphere of Tersane Istanbul—a historic shipyard transformed into a contemporary waterfront destination—perfectly reflected the spirit of the summit. Highlighting Türkiye's rise as a global superyacht hub, the event brought together more than 450 industry leaders, designers, shipyard representatives, and finance experts from over 20 countries, once again underscoring the international community's strong interest in Türkiye.

The summit opened with a heartfelt tribute to Halit Yukay, a visionary seafarer



and a lasting source of inspiration for the Turkish maritime community. The opening session, hosted by Invest in Türkiye, set the tone by emphasizing the growing international collaborations shaping the country's yachting ecosystem.

Summit Highlights

Growing stronger in its third year, SST welcomed over 31 international speakers and professionals from a wide range of industry segments. Along the waterfront, tender exhibitions by brands such as Hunter, Mercedes, Saxdor, and VisionF drew significant attention, while scale models from leading Turkish shipyards including Mengi Yay and Turquoise stood as quiet yet powerful proof of Türkiye's advanced engineering and design capabilities.



Masterclasses hosted by Volvo Penta and OmniAccess provided technical insight and forward-looking perspectives for a broad audience, from captains to yacht owners. One of the summit's standout experiences was a specially organized Ses Yachts shipyard tour, offering participants a first-hand look at craftsmanship and ongoing projects on site.

While the main sessions were held at Tersane Istanbul, the second day's program took place at 2Plan Terminal. Networking opportunities were further enriched by an elegant cocktail evening hosted at DG Art Gallery.

A Strong Global Statement from Istanbul

Across two days of debates, panels, and networking sessions, Superyacht Summit Türkiye 2025 transcended the boundaries of a conventional industry event. This year, Istanbul clearly positioned itself not only as a center of production and refit expertise, but also as a hub for design, innovation, and global collaboration.

As SST'25 reaffirmed Türkiye's rising role in the superyacht world, it also sent a strong signal that the strategic dialogue shaping the future of the industry will continue to evolve around Istanbul in the years ahead.



Industry-Shaping Discussions

The panel titled "Türkiye 2025: Challenges & Opportunities for the World's #2 Builder" examined the country's evolution from a regional shipbuilding hub into a global benchmark for innovation and craftsmanship.

Renowned designer Dickie Bannenberg, one of the most influential figures in the industry, captivated the audience by sharing insights into the creative processes behind iconic projects and how extraordinary client expectations are met. His reflections on color palette choices inspired by the original Spitfire heritage were particularly engaging for design enthusiasts.

In the session "Inside the American Buyer's Mind: Tariffs, Trends & Big Opportunities," behavioral patterns in the U.S. market were explored, while Begüm Doğulu highlighted Türkiye's transformation in yacht tourism and agency services.

The panel "Charter as a Lifestyle: Why Destinations Sell the Yacht" brought international perspectives on Türkiye's marinas, cruising routes, and luxury charter potential.

Adding a different dimension, Ian Petts analyzed how families protect assets such as yachts and jets, and why up to 90% of wealth can dissipate by the third generation, offering a compelling and thought-provoking outlook.

YAT NEWS TÜRKİYE 2025, REPORT CARD

The Global Showcase Of Turkish Yachting

2025 will be remembered as a year in which Yat New Türkiye expanded its editorial boundaries and further strengthened the international visibility of the Turkish yachting industry. Throughout the year, the publication actively took part in key touchpoints both in Türkiye and abroad, with the aim of carrying the sector's diverse components onto the global stage.

Presence On The World Stage

Throughout 2025, Yat New Türkiye closely followed leading international events where the Turkish yachting sector engaged directly with global stakeholders:

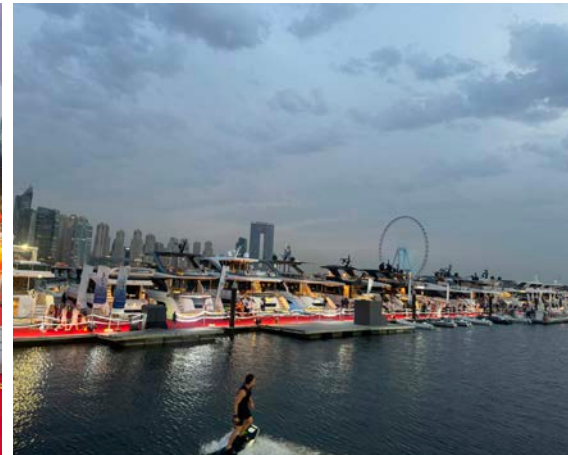
- Boot Düsseldorf
- Dubai International Boat Show
- Monaco Yacht Show
- METSTRADE
- Superyacht Summit Türkiye – Press Sponsor
- TYBA Yacht Charter Show

These events served as key platforms for showcasing the design approach, engineering capability, and sectoral vision of Turkish manufacturers to a global audience.

Boot Düsseldorf



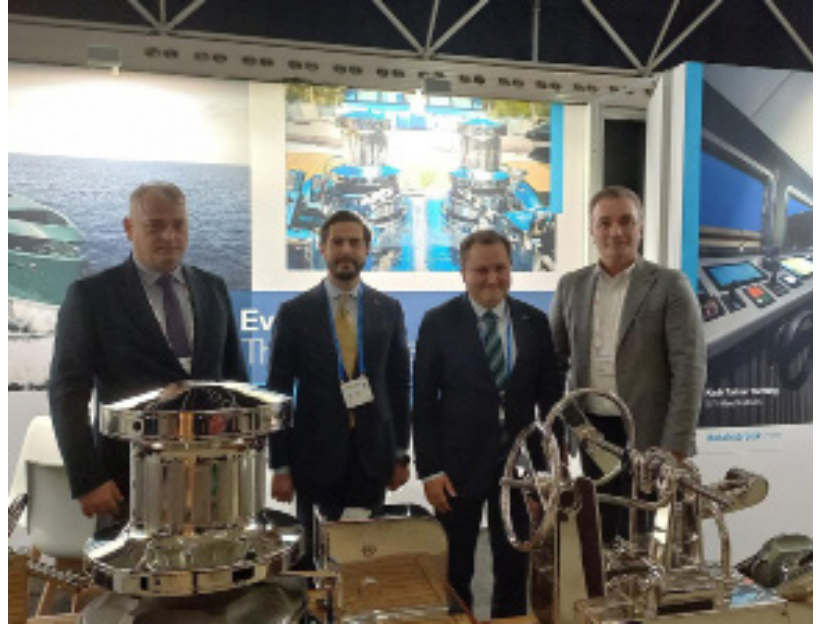
Dubai International Boat Show



Monaco Yacht Show



METSTRADE



TYBA Yacht Charter Show



Taking the Pulse of the Sector in Türkiye

Major domestic boat shows were monitored on site, allowing market dynamics and production trends to be evaluated directly from the field:

- İzmir Boat Show
- Antalya Boat Show
- Bodrum Boat Show
- Pendik Boat Show
- Bosphorus Boat Show – Land Exhibition

These engagements provided a holistic perspective on the current state and direction of the Turkish yachting industry.

İzmir Boat Show



Antalya Boat Show



Bodrum Boat Show



Bosphorus Boat Show – Land Exhibition





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Strategic Field Dossier: Antalya Free Zone & Nuh Industrial Site

One of the standout editorial works of 2025 was an in-depth field dossier focusing on Türkiye's key production hubs. Shipyards, subcontractors, and equipment manufacturers operating in the Antalya Free Zone and Nuh Industrial Site were examined on site.

This study resulted in a clear, verifiable, and reference-quality inventory covering:

- Production capacity of the region
- Areas of specialization
- Company profiles
- Future potential

Editorial Approach

The editorial line followed throughout 2025 highlighted the core elements defining Yat New Türkiye's position within the industry:

- An internationally oriented editorial language
- Field-based, reliable content production
- In-depth analytical feature files
- An independent editorial stance prioritizing institutional credibility

This approach positioned Yat New Türkiye beyond a news outlet, establishing it as a lasting reference point for both the present and future of the sector.

2025 Closing Note

This publishing journey, driven by the goal of enhancing the global visibility of the Turkish yachting industry, continues to grow together with its stakeholders.

Yat Haber Türkiye enters 2026 with a broader international network, deeper editorial content, and a stronger, more defined editorial vision.



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A New Brand from YAF Group for the Yachting Sector: MEA YACHT

YAF Group, which has delivered strong projects in the Turkish shipbuilding and maritime sector for many years, officially announced its new yachting brand, MEA YACHT, during the “Hello 2026” night. In his speech at the year-end gathering, Group CEO Yusuf Kanıcı emphasized that this new initiative should not be seen merely as the establishment of a new company, but rather as the transfer of deep-rooted maritime expertise into the world of yachting.

Reflecting on a challenging year, Kanıcı stated that the group moved forward not only with production and delivery successes, but also with new, future-oriented projects. Sharing the establishment of MEA YACHT as one of the key steps of this vision, he underlined their aim to provide comprehensive, high-quality and trust-focused services to the yachting sector.

From Shipbuilding to Yachting: A Legacy of Expertise

MEA YACHT aims to integrate YAF Group’s operational strength and experience gained in shipbuilding, maintenance and repair, equipment, and spare parts supply into the yachting sector. The new brand covers a wide range of services, including yacht equipment and spare parts supply, repair and maintenance services, crew solutions, yacht management, sales & purchase (S&P), and newbuild processes.

Highlighting this approach, CEO Yusuf Kanıcı stated that their goal is to establish a holistic structure in the yachting sector rather than fragmented services, with quality and continuity forming the cornerstone of the new brand.

A New Structure Strengthened by Strategic Partnership

MEA YACHT was launched through a new partnership with Captain Sevinç Körüklü. Kanıcı noted that this collaboration strengthens their perspective on the yachting sector, emphasizing that MEA YACHT will stand out not only through technical capability, but also through operational experience and hands-on field knowledge.

The brand’s objective is to create a reliable, long-term business model that offers one-stop solutions for yacht owners, professionals, and business partners.

A New Era in the Yachting Sector

The establishment of MEA YACHT is seen as the beginning of a new era in which YAF Group’s disciplined production approach from commercial shipping meets the specialized expectations of the yachting world. With this new brand, the group prioritizes the right service, right timing, and lasting partnerships over sheer scale.

Announced as 2026 begins, this new initiative aims to make a strong contribution to Turkish yachting by supporting an engineering-driven, trustworthy, and sustainable growth vision.



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A New Generation of Yacht Design Took the Stage in Türkiye

One of the most established organizations aiming to bring young yacht and ship designers into the sector in Türkiye, the National Ship and Yacht Design Competition, was held for the 14th time this year.

Organized annually by the Ship, Yacht and Services Exporters' Association (GYHİB) under the coordination of the Ministry of Trade, the competition stands out as more than just an award program; it is a long-term sectoral investment that nurtures Türkiye's culture of design, engineering, and production.

This year, the competition theme was set as "Motorized Sailing Boat (Motorsailer) Design Under 24 Meters." On the final night, 49 students from different universities presented 17 projects to the jury. The young designers were evaluated not only on their aesthetic approach but also on projects that required mandatory engineering calculations.



Award-Winning Projects

Following the jury's evaluation:

- **First Prize:**
NOVA : Ali Tayip Yıldız and Emre Büyükbayraktaroğlu
Yıldız Technical University
- **Second Prize:**
APEIRON : Zeynep Gülsüm Ağbulut, Eylül Arslanbay, Ersin Doğan, Kaan Kırmızıgül
Istanbul Technical University, Rumeli University and Yıldız Technical University
- **Third Prize:**
EL TURCO : Yağmur Yılmaz, Hüseyin Ensar Söylemez, Yiğit Can
Yeditepe University and Yıldız Technical University
- **Türk Loydu Special Award:**
PEDASA 78 : Can Özdemir and Muhammet Emin Önal
Piri Reis University and Maltepe University

Projects ranking in the competition received cash prizes of up to TRY 180,000, while the recipients of the Türk Loydu Special Award were presented with a prize of TRY 60,000.

More Than a Competition

One of the key features that distinguishes the National Ship and Yacht Design Competition from similar events is the requirement that each team must include at least one student from shipbuilding, marine engineering, or marine technologies engineering. The demand for detailed engineering calculations, in addition to design, brings the competition closer to real production processes.

At the end of the ceremony, it was announced that the theme of the 2026 competition will be "Tugboat Design."

With its structure that supports young designers, encourages innovation, and aims to sustainably develop yacht design culture, the National Ship and Yacht Design Competition stands out as one of the most important investments in the future of the sector in Türkiye.





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